

1. Introduction:

This report presents a descriptive analysis of the Ethiopian diaspora in Canada—an increasingly vibrant and growing community. The objective is to provide a high-level overview of key demographic, educational, occupational, and economic indicators to better understand the evolving profile and socio-economic integration of Ethiopians in Canada. Drawing primarily on open-source datasets, including the Canadian Census from 2001 to 2021 and select publications from Statistics Canada, the analysis aggregates data across two decades to identify patterns and notable shifts within the community. While this report does not aim to diagnose root causes or provide policy prescriptions, it serves as a foundational resource that can inform further research, community programming, and policy development.

2. Data & Methods:

2.1 Data Sources:

The data used in this report were primarily obtained from the **Canadian Census** conducted by **Statistics Canada** for the years **2001, 2006, 2011, 2016, and 2021**. These datasets were accessed through two main platforms:

- **ODESI (Ontario Data Documentation, Extraction Service and Infrastructure Initiative)** – <https://odesi.ca/en/>
A digital repository that provides access to a wide range of social science data, including public use microdata files and census special interest profiles.
- **Statistics Canada** – <https://www.statcan.gc.ca>
The national statistical office that offers open access to comprehensive datasets and analytical reports, including the Census Profile and custom tabulations relevant to ethnicity, immigration, education, income, and employment.

The report utilizes **special interest profiles** and **custom tabulated data** focusing on the Ethiopian population in Canada, including variables related to generational status, household composition, marital status, educational attainment, field of study, income distribution, employment sectors, and geographic location.

In instances where a specific "Ethiopian" ethnic category was not available in a dataset (particularly in earlier census years), broader categories such as "Black" or "African" were used. In such cases, the **proportional representation of Ethiopians within that broader group**—based on available demographic estimates—was applied to scale the data more accurately to reflect the Ethiopian population.

2.2 Data Preparation:

To enable a coherent and consistent analysis across the five census years, all datasets were cleaned, standardized, and combined into a unified structure. This involved harmonizing variable names, definitions, and classifications, which often differed between census years due to evolving survey design and terminology.

Custom groupings were introduced to consolidate sub-categories into more meaningful and interpretable classifications, especially where certain categories were missing, overly granular, or inconsistent. This standardization was essential for minimizing ambiguity and enabling trend analysis over time.

Key variables—including **Age**, **Education**, **Income**, **Occupation**, and **Industry**—were re-categorized to preserve analytical specificity while avoiding overcrowding in data visualizations. These groupings were carefully designed to balance detail with clarity, ensuring that trends could be effectively compared without sacrificing important distinctions.

This data preparation process was a critical step in enabling longitudinal analysis, making it possible to observe the evolving socioeconomic landscape of the Ethiopian diaspora in Canada over the 20-year span of census data.

2.3 Statistical Analyses

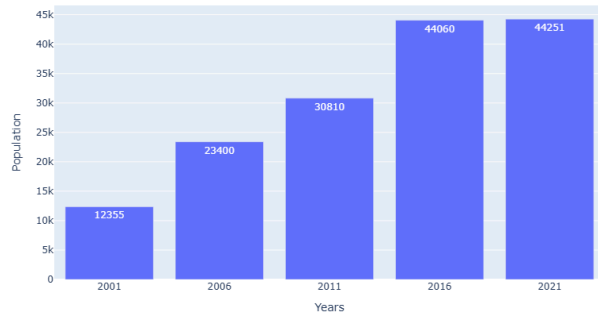
This report used descriptive statistical methods focused on aggregation and visualization to examine demographic and socioeconomic trends within the Ethiopian diaspora from 2001 to 2021. Standardized groupings were applied across census datasets to ensure consistency in key variables such as generation status, education, occupation, income, and region.

Visual tools—including bar charts, area plots, and density maps—were used to highlight trends over time and across geography. Categories were streamlined to reduce complexity while preserving meaningful distinctions. Spatial analysis, enabled by coordinate data, showed regional shifts, particularly increased settlement in Alberta. While no inferential tests were conducted, the visual analysis provides a strong foundation for identifying trends and informing future research.

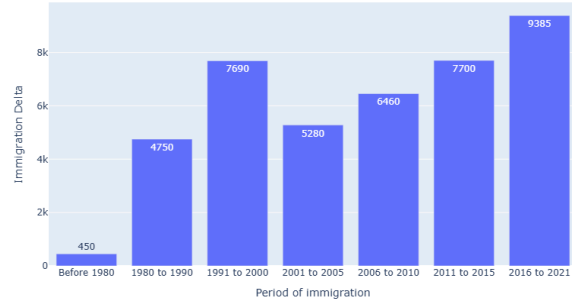
3. Results:

3.1 Population and Immigration:

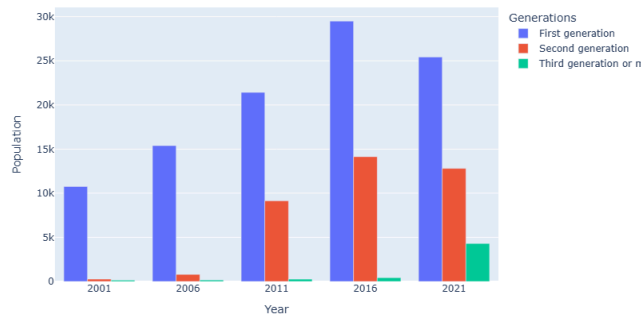
Ethiopian Population in Canada



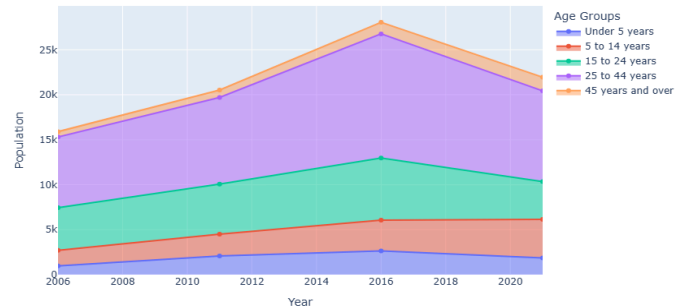
Immigration History from Ethiopia



Immigration Generations of Ethiopians



Age Groups of Ethiopians (2006-21)

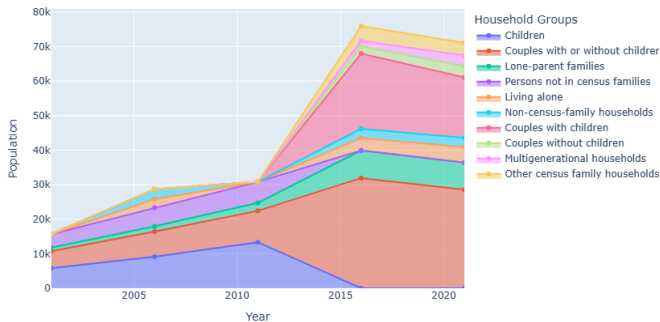


- Immigration and generational data highlight the relative youthfulness of the Ethiopian diaspora in Canada. As this population matures, it is essential to ensure equitable access to higher education and facilitate successful entry into the labour market.
- First-generation Ethiopians still form the majority but are plateauing or slightly declining post-2016.
- Second-generation Ethiopians have grown steadily, showing community stabilization and long-term settlement.
- A small but notable third-generation population appears by 2021, indicating early roots of multi-generational diaspora.
- The age categories in the 20XX dataset differ from other years. Several ranges (e.g., "5–19 years", "20–39 years") overlap multiple standard age brackets used in subsequent

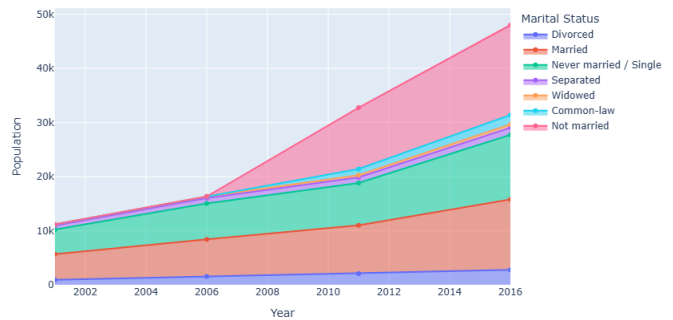
consensus data and in this report. As a result, this year's data is not included to maintain consistency

3.2 Household and Marital Status:

Household Composition of Ethiopians (2001-21)



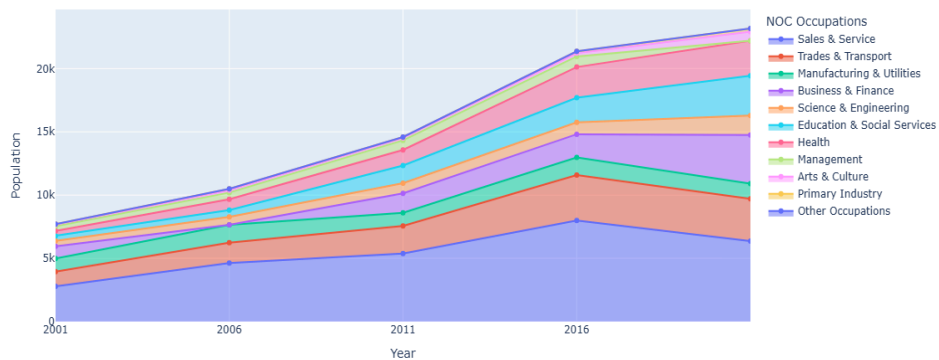
Marital Status of Ethiopians (2001-21)



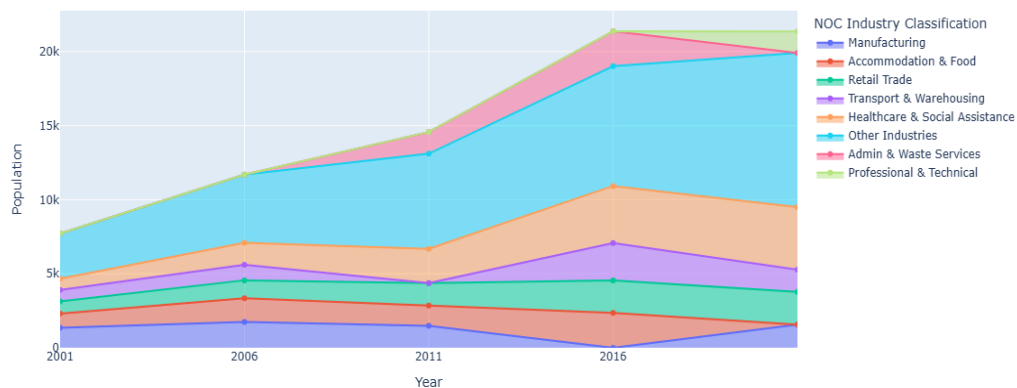
- A significant portion of Ethiopian immigrants in Canada live in family-based households, **particularly as couples with or without children**—indicating that many are arriving as or forming young families.
- The growth of young family households underscores the importance of affordable housing policies and accessible social services (e.g., childcare, education, healthcare) to support long-term integration and well-being.
- **"Couples with or without children"** and **"Lone-parent families"** have seen consistent growth, indicating an increase in nuclear and single-parent households.
- A significant rise in **"Persons not in census families"** suggests more individuals are living alone, with roommates, or in non-traditional arrangements—possibly younger adults or recent immigrants.
- **"Multigenerational households"** and **"Other census family households"** saw a notable increase post-2011, likely due to economic pressures, cultural preferences, or housing limitations, particularly in urban centers.
- **"Children"** as a household group disappeared after 2011—likely due to changes in how census data classifies children in family contexts.

3.3 Labor and Industry:

NOC Occupational Classification of Ethiopian Labor Force (2001-21)



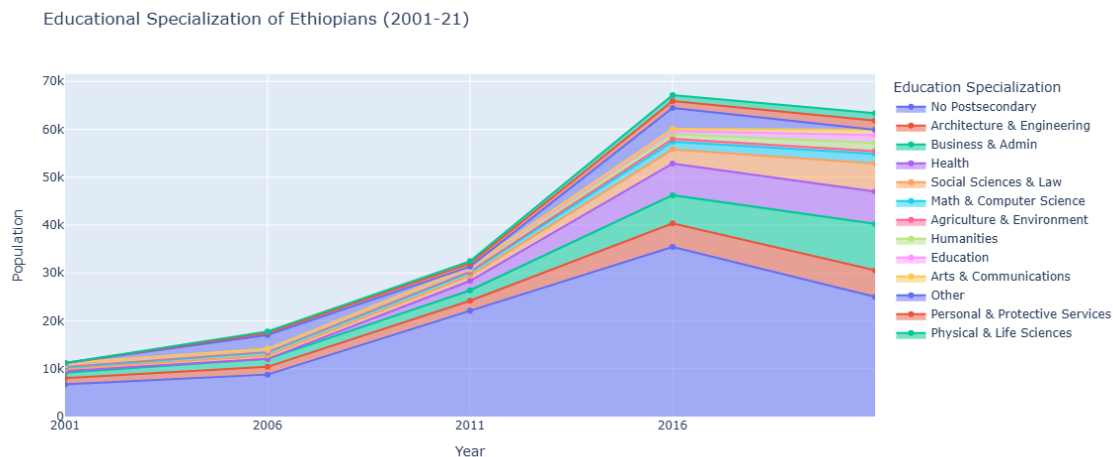
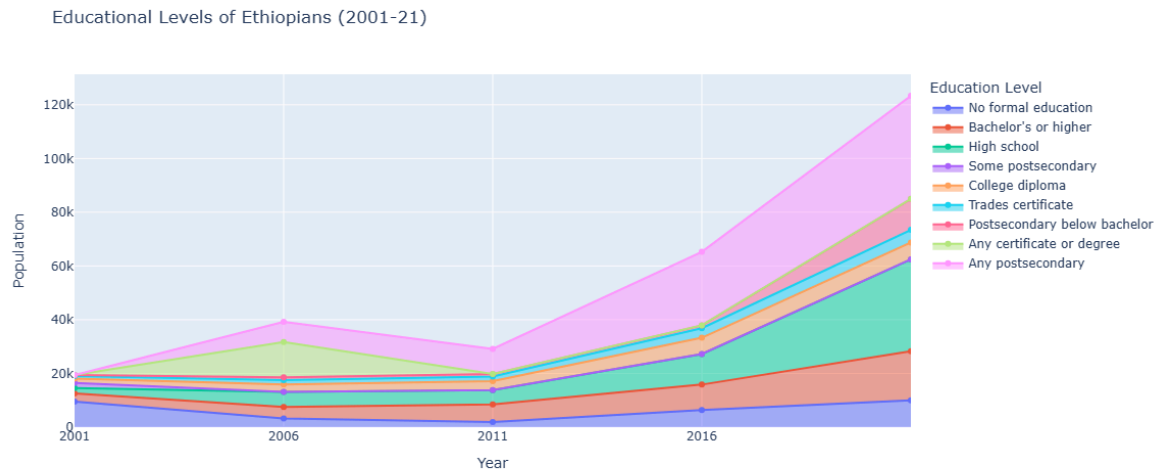
NOC Industry Classification of Ethiopian Labor Force (2001-21)



- With an increase in Ethiopian population we also see an increased participation in key-industries within Canada, with Health, Business and Finance, Educational and Social Services seeing an increase since 2016. Expanding their presence in Retail/Sales and Healthcare.
- **Sales & Service roles remained the largest occupational group** throughout the period but declined proportionally as other categories grew. Notably, there was a **significant rise in Business & Finance and Education & Social Services occupations** — reflecting broader professional diversification.
- Modest presence in Finance, Professional Services, or IT industries may reflect barriers or lag in recognition of foreign qualifications.

- Underrepresentation in high-status professions like Health or STEM signals potential underemployment or credentialing barriers.
- **"Other Industries"** (likely a catch-all for multiple sectors) saw consistent growth, but healthcare and professional/technical services saw especially notable increases. This reflects the impact of higher education and credential recognition, especially in health-related fields.

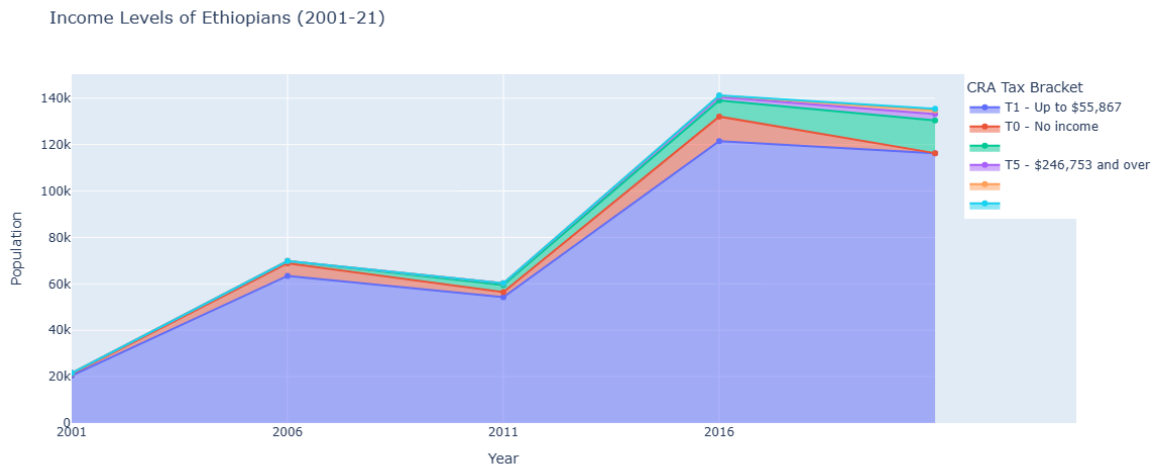
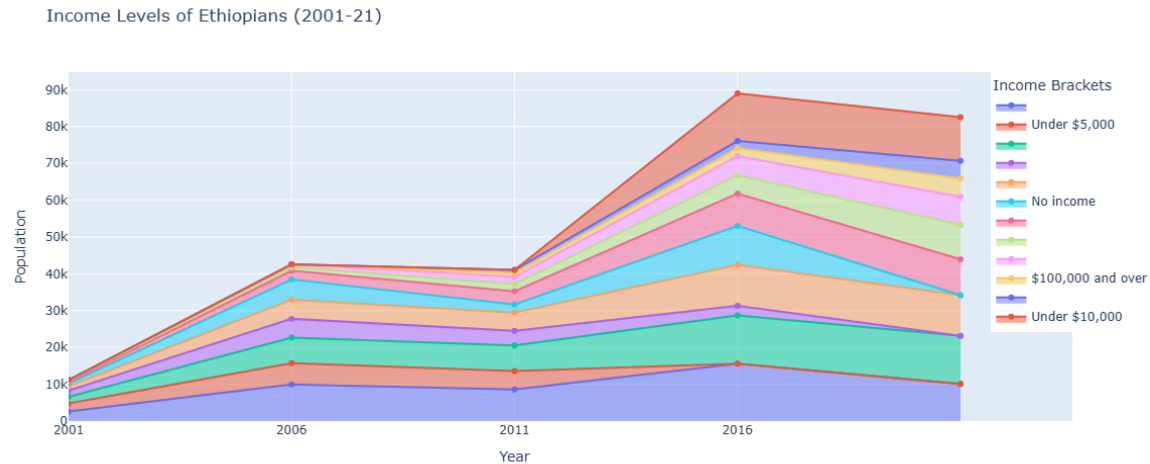
3.4 Education:



- Between 2001 and 2021, there was a marked increase in the proportion of Ethiopians attaining postsecondary education. The most substantial growth occurred in the **"Bachelor's or higher"** category, especially after 2011.
- While there's strong growth in educational attainment over time, **a majority of Ethiopians in the dataset still do not hold a postsecondary credential** — making "No Postsecondary" the dominant group in specialization charts. But among those who do, **Business, Health, and Social Sciences** are the most popular fields.

- While “**No formal education**” and “**High school only**” levels saw early dominance, their proportions declined over time, indicating a gradual educational uplift within the community.

3.5 Income and Wealth:

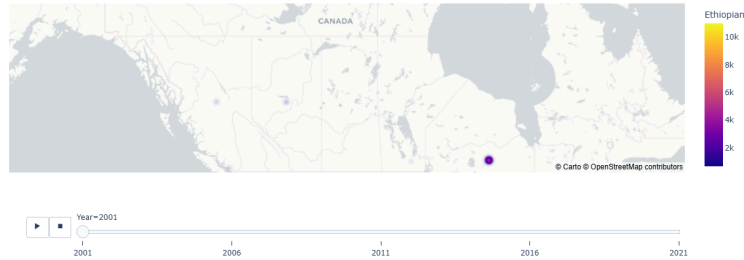


- As the Ethiopian diaspora grows, there is a general upward trend in income levels. This appears to align with rising educational attainment—particularly among the younger generation—who are increasingly graduating from health and business programs, leading to improved employment opportunities and higher wages.
- Income levels among Ethiopians have risen steadily since 2001. A larger share of the population now earns above \$60,000, with growing representation even in the \$100,000+ bracket post-2016.

- Conversely, the proportion of individuals without income or earning below \$10,000 declined steadily, although it remains significant.
- However, the large majority of Ethiopians remain low-income, with some improvement noted in the wealth of the diaspora.
- This may be due to easy access to well-paying jobs and educational enhancements, in highly-lucrative fields such as tech and healthcare.

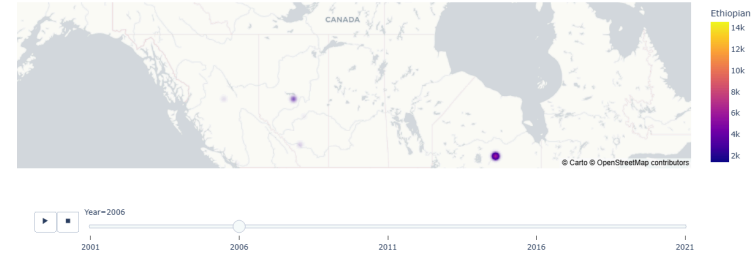
3.6 Population Density:

Population Density of Ethiopians in Canada



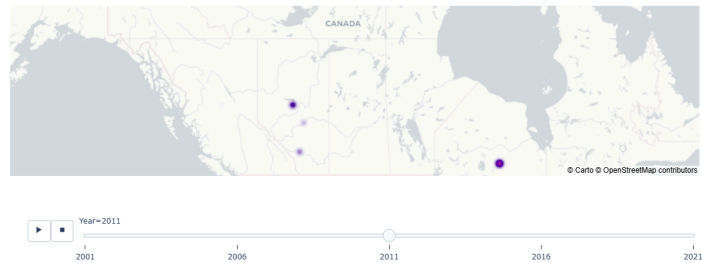
Ethiopian Population Density 2001

Population Density of Ethiopians in Canada



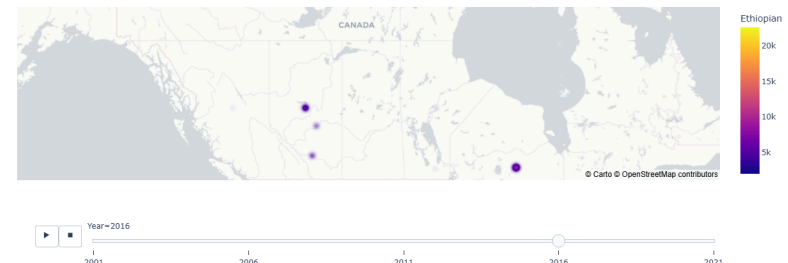
Ethiopian Population Density 2006

Population Density of Ethiopians in Canada



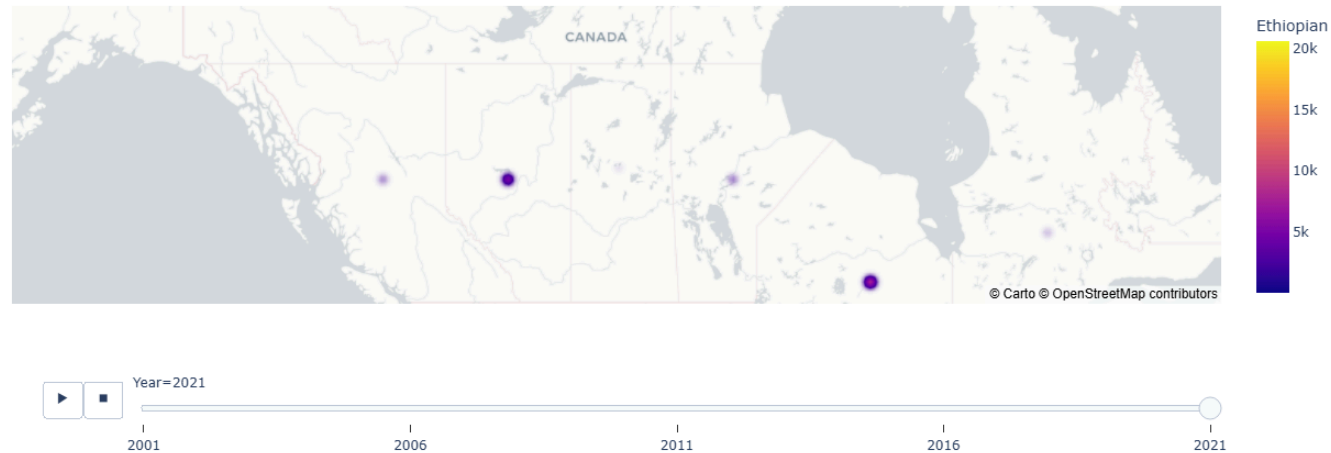
Ethiopian Population Density 2016

Population Density of Ethiopians in Canada



Ethiopian Population Density 2021

Population Density of Ethiopians in Canada



Ethiopian Population Density 2021

- The data indicates a westward shift in the population density of the Ethiopian diaspora in Canada, beginning in 2001. The most recent census records show a significant concentration of Ethiopians residing in Alberta.
- This trend may be attributed to several factors, including Alberta's relatively strong job market in sectors such as healthcare, trades, and service industries, as well as the province's historically lower cost of living compared to other major metropolitan areas like Toronto and Vancouver.
- Additionally, access to affordable housing, growing immigrant communities, and targeted provincial immigration programs may have further contributed to the increased settlement in Western Canada.

4. Conclusion & Discussion:

The Ethiopian diaspora in Canada has grown steadily over the past two decades, characterized by a predominantly young and increasingly educated population. Patterns in immigration generation, educational attainment, occupational distribution, and income levels reveal a community undergoing significant socioeconomic integration. While there is notable progress in postsecondary education and entry into high-skilled professions such as healthcare, business, and engineering, disparities persist—particularly in income distribution and representation in leadership roles. Household and family composition data underscore the prevalence of young families and youth, highlighting the importance of affordable housing, access to social services, and equitable pathways into the labor market.

Furthermore, geographic distribution trends indicate a shift toward Western Canada, particularly Alberta, likely driven by employment opportunities, lower living costs, and community support structures. To support this growing population, targeted policies and culturally responsive services must be prioritized to ensure equitable participation and long-term well-being within Canadian society.

For more targeted and meaningful insights into the Ethiopian population specifically, future research must utilize more granular datasets, tailored surveys, or community-level data collection efforts. Such refinement is necessary to accurately assess the unique needs, contributions, and barriers faced by this dynamic and growing population.
